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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Monday, May 6, 2024

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WyMFhgaN2Zs
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:04:43] Good afternoon everyone. This is the main meeting of the College Partnership Laboratory Standing Committee, and I'm joined by the Chair of the Committee. Dr. Armstrong, would you call the role of the members of the Standing Committee? Present.

[00:05:00] Mr. Baylor. i will note that i have approved your remote participation of mr john bailey under the board's bylaws under section 2.2 3708.3 in the code of virginia such participation is allowed because his principal residence is more than 60 miles from the meeting location identified in the

[00:05:37] At this time, if you would please join me in a moment of silence, follow by the pledge of allegiance.

[00:06:11] All right. Thank you for that moment of settling. I have noticed that we don't have an American flag at the moment today, so we will unfortunately have to dispense with the pledge of allegiance, but we will certainly do so at our next meeting.

[00:06:31] All right. At this time, we're going to move to the approval of the amended agenda. staff passed out amended minutes for all the committee members to review hopefully you had a chance to peruse those items i'm going to pause make sure everyone's had a chance to review the minutes and once you're getting kind of a nod i'll proceed with the approval of those

[00:07:10] so you're ready you're ready

[00:08:04] okay is there a motion to approve the amended minutes so moved is there a second second all those in favor of the motion please signify by stating aye the chair goes aye any opposed vote statement all right the minutes are at this time i'll move to approval of the amended agenda is there a motion to approve the amended agenda so is there a second so all those in favor of improving the motion please signify by saying aye aye chair votes aye as well any opposed statement

[00:08:44] the motion is unanimously approved that includes your application and modify the agenda at this time we're going to move on to an update from mr hansen um our vice president of the virginia state board of education as well as the standing committee member who's going to provide the standing committee with an update on last month's state board of education and the deliberation well thank you just um when we met two weeks ago um we did approve the six lap schools are up to final approval and including emory and henry uh george mason university roanoke college old

[00:09:22] dominion the new court means in old dominion chesapeake and the paul decant community college and all of those were approved with an eight to one vote with the exception of George Mason where we had a board member that needed to recuse herself so I think also just the conversation was incredibly appreciative of the quality of the applications that had come through and also to the work of this committee and the work of the staff at the Department of Education for their diligence

[00:09:58] and helping to work with each of the applicants to ensure their outcomes will be reaching the standards in the hopes that we are expecting and student achievement and performance and impact in their respective communities. So it was pretty much an evaluation for the community.

[00:10:24] Thank you, Mr. Hansen. Any questions for Mr. Hansen or Mr. Rockham, would you like to add on to that? and uh no thank you i think that covers all right thank you mr hansom at this time we'll move to public comment on agenda items dr armstrong members of the public to speak with agenda items uh no i'm not sure okay thank you um the standing committee accepts public comment on all matters related to college partnership laboratory schools in virginia public comments important consideration and the value to the standing committee um due to the cost of all the travel we certainly encourage

[00:11:00] members of the public uh to submit written comments as well as certain anytime to come and attend meetings at this time we're going to move to item a which is action items items for discussion which is first and final review of the college partnership laboratory school application from richard bland community college the committee will be hearing from dr kim boy from richard bland community college follow our staff report from dr armstrong please mr chairman pleasure to see

[00:11:36] good morning um today we're looking forward to receiving your presentation um we and staff have advised you you can have roughly 10 minutes to make your presentation then we will see if there are any other members of your team that are here that would like to speak to your application and improve the partnership your collaboration your interest in it then we'll go to dr armstrong he'll get his staff apart and then we'll go to questions from the committee so just so you have a sense of what to expect when it is about the show. So please, proceed.

[00:12:14] Chair Wodiska, thank you so much. This has been a long journey, and we are delighted to be here today. And I am Debbie Saito. I'm president of Richard Bland College. And I would just like to kind of

set the stage for Dr. Boyd and Mr. Pritchett as I inform the committee that Richard Bland is a one-of-a-kind Virginia college. We offer the complete student experience in years one

[00:12:43] and two, residential, athletics, a very robust platform of student clubs, activities, and we are presenting this application building on the strengths of Richard Bland College, especially over the last decade. We have gone from a handful of dual enrollment students to now 2,000 students who are enrolled in high school and college simultaneously. So that is one of the strengths that we're really building on with this partnership. Another strength that we've been

[00:13:20] working on for more than a decade is the customization or personalization of the educational experience, taking students where they are and then helping them to develop the pathway with experienced learner mentors, guiding, recommending tutoring or support services. But it's a program called Guided Pathways to Success. And it truly is sort of personalized or customized pathways.

[00:13:52] So you will hear elements of that in the presentation today. We have a new building that will open this fall, the Academic Innovation Center, equipped with a virtual reality laboratory. This is where the lab school will reside.

[00:14:12] This is where students will convene in this brand new building with state-of-the-art technology that is integrated into the educational experience for our lab school students. And finally, as I transition to Dr. Boyd and her presentation, Dr. Boyd is vice president.

[00:14:34] She oversees the Department of Research and Innovation. So, as you hear the presentation, I really want to underline research and innovation. These are component parts of our lab school that we believe is going to set this apart in ways that have tremendous value for the students we serve. Dr. Boyd.

[00:15:00] Okay, so I'm not quite sure how to cue the video. Thank you.

[00:15:12] home street college lab school is all about creating a broader impact students can have a campus of mind and workplace discipline that demonstrate engagement critical thinking and and advocacy towards them.

[00:15:49] - We want to be able to become a medical practitioner.

[00:16:18] Help us start our lives with great students, self-adventing, college-run programs, moving patients and the ability to face death. Help us start our lives with great students. High school's curriculum will utilize virtual reality to increase STEM interest and performance and build STEM learning environment.

[00:16:40] - I'm on the pathway to get insertions in science today. - Help us start our lives with great students. We're also including a diversity and leadership program. Persuasion is a part of our daily life from practitioners. We care about our saving, and we're going to support the teachers, and teachers in training.

[00:17:09] So many volunteers coming in here in the 30s. This project is aligned to the new Richard Lane innovation that has broken ground from the completion date of fiscal year 2024 and we are going to take a really aggressive approach to building a lifting of arts to the home argument that's really important how we start our last school week our aim is to provide a

[00:17:47] collective sim training program designed to enhance several armies among underrepresented my students i will start my school we will leverage the strength of five new versions

[00:18:17] we also propose to develop mightiest techniques that stimulates them folks while engaging our students help us start our basketball our general pathways to stem careers will develop new pathways to pursue providing and automation training as we look to increase collaboration with industry partners need to seek help and we'll invest $10 million to establish the new testing training

[00:18:54] an rnv center at richard land college we will develop partnerships with co-origines to expand our recent computer science offerings within the 19th grade book we will increase diversity amongst our students with stackable certifications through the pursuit of stem associate and will give me i'm on the pathway to become the way for you guys

[00:19:35] tomorrow's future today rnc the next i gladly knew that today was time to launch a lab school the lab school focused on STEM career opportunities thank you thank you so our purpose is to create a space for innovation and engagement we're actually coming from a place

[00:20:09] of community need together we built this proposal we started with Petersburg city public school a year before the lab school application even came out we actually conducted research with 382 students in the area around engagement with virtual reality and stem activities that show so much progress that we're excited to put it into this lab school our goal is to build motivation interest and aspiration we have a purposeful partnership with petersburg i'll let mr pritchard speech but with a speak but with a focus of representing underrepresented and underserved

[00:20:49] students our goal is to build from what we already see in our community is a creative spirit a creative nature it's to actually focus on how many of our students are resilient and how they move forward with purpose and to help us build stronger knowledge base and scholarship mr pritchett yes good morning just wanted to say again we're excited about the partnership we have been a the partnership has been in place with Richard Blaine I believe since about 2008 when we started our dual enrollment program and just so excited because now we are we have increased the partnership

[00:21:25] with VCU Dr. Ken McKnight we actually we're actually bringing on Virginia State University and we're bringing on Bryan Australia College and we are also bringing on Richard Blaine where we're building a program for teachers for Petersburg which is outstanding we're talking about teachers once they receive their two-year degree they will go on and for the next two years to get their bachelor's they will actually go on and get their bachelor's degree for free and we're excited about that department of education has assisted us with the funding and so we're just excited because we we're going to be able to now have certified more certified teachers in our

[00:22:01] classroom because of the partnership but the lab school gives us other opportunities as far as educational opportunities for our students something that we've had a hard time providing and parents have wanted other options so this is another option and we're excited about it and hopefully it will move forward thank you there we go okay so global academy is what we've loved when we started referring to it as um students remain in their in they're enrolled in their home school but they are offered two paths one path is for students that have an interest and

[00:22:40] ability in STEAM. And another path is for students who will gain confidence and efficacy in preparation for STEAM. So one of the questions that came up, I'd like to address here. The way this Globe Academy is presented, the main trajectory and track is STEM, science, technology, engineering, and math. And surrounding it is art. We're using art towards art visioning.

[00:23:07] We had a request, even from our partners, to actually look at middle schools and work with them with art programs to engage them and have them ready to be our next lab school participants. But in addition, we're actually using art visioning for career pathways.

[00:23:23] If you visualize where you're at now and you have visions of where you want to go in the future, what do you have to put in place to follow that path? And the second realm around that is health. It is because we actually want to have students look at health within, how are you taking care of your body, but most importantly, health outside, your mental health and how that influences your engagement in STEM.

[00:23:48] We will actually handle that piece with our partners, Bonsecure and Southside Regional Medical Center, who has agreed to come and do summer programs and be a part of one of our weekends out of the month programs and participate on various levels.

[00:24:03] So we are excited about the holistic approach of our program. So another question also came up about customization. So here's how that is. That's why we wanted to start with the video, because we're able to be small and nimble and to allow students to participate in things that are engaging to them, that excites them.

[00:24:26] So here's how that looks. On a monthly basis, we have two weekends a month where all of the students, whether you're supplemental or optional, you'll be able to come in in their boot camps. That's where we're teaching you the basics, the math, the science. We're drilling it in. Yes, we're drilling it in. But summer programs are allowed to focus on students' interests. So we have a math and drones program for individuals interested in drones. We have a virtual reality with biology where you travel through the body and different summer programs that stimulate. So again, two

[00:25:02] tracks, those with the ability and interest, and those that we want to build confidence. The confidence track is the supplemental track, where we're aiming to reach 375 students. That is summer residential academy, three to six weeks, weekend college, after school, weekly tutoring and instruction, three-tiered mentoring, and those summer programs that I referenced earlier. I'm trying to make sure I get this all in eight minutes. The second program is the optional program.

[00:25:28] Now, here is where we double down. These are the students that have ability in STEM. These are our dual enrollment towards associate degree students, but they'll also have advanced STEAM research teams. They'll have separate summer residential academy programs, still a part of our three-tiered mentoring, but more internships and externships and enhanced experiential learning opportunities.

[00:25:49] So question becomes, how many do we imagine to fit in our dual enrollment program? So there's that 25 core, but the 75 students that we saw in the supplemental, they'll be allowed to take dual enrollment courses as it fits in their trajectory. We're actually taking them through a stage of change approach.

[00:26:07] We want to look at their strengths and build from where they're at. So move them upstairs based on their level, since they'll be coming in at different levels. we want to honor that and look at what works best for them. Here is a breakdown of where we see ourselves today. We'll start year one with 25 students. We'll move on to year two with 25 11th and 12th graders. By year three, when we have things moving and we have our models and everything outlined, we bring in our rural schools, we bring in Sussex, we bring in Prince George. In our application, you'll saw we already have memorandums of understanding with them,

[00:26:45] And they've already announced that they want to support the lab school vision. Okay, pathways. So the goal behind this entire program is STEM pathways, education, two and four year degrees pursuits, natural and behavioral sciences focused, health professions.

[00:27:07] We're working with our partners with aviation, with drones, with virtual reality, augmented reality. We've recently, last week, started working with a group called Emica, where they do artificial intelligence or robotics, and they're interested in coming in and being a part of this lab school.

[00:27:23] But we'll build from our faculty expertise and curriculum. We have amazing physics faculty, biology faculty, and they will help us discover and increase evidence-based practices. But finally, as Dr. Saito mentioned, all of this will take place in our academic innovation center that is now set to be online, basically, now, by July.

[00:27:46] It is looking very lovely. So the bottom line that I want to bring up is we are outcome driven. So we want to be able to do rapid feedback, assessment. This is working, this is what's not working, and be able to make sure we create learning environments that's standard, meeting all of the regular high school requirements and enhance did i do it in time um before you proceed i'm just going to ask one quick clarifying question that may bear on our deliberation this morning um in your remarks you mentioned that vcu might be a partner in your

[00:28:24] application and when we reviewed the application i did not see vcu mentioned so i just want to inquire is VCU a partner in your application so here's the reason I'm asking is if that's the case I have to accuse myself of consideration of the application. VCU is not a partner in our application what Mr. Pritchard and what I'm referring to is VCU we have a university center and in our university center we look at any partners in any directions we can move we're participating with VCU through our university center with a 2-2. Thank you sports fans I just

[00:28:57] wanted to triple check that from yes make sure I didn't hear that in the record okay um for our usual procedure I certainly want to go back and see you know president do you have any other remarks that you would like to share regarding your community college Mr Critchard just share your board uh otherwise we'll see if there are any other individuals from your community that would like to speak to that nothing else I just want to say that this this is a long time this process started way back so i'm just excited to be here like i said and hopefully this is something that

[00:29:33] we can have in eaglesburg for our students because they really need it thank you um would you like to recognize and have a statement to support from any members of your community that are here today yeah dr hamley so any of you uh any gentlemen i see you moving the microphone right your son or my chair chair members of the board all assembled and my colleagues to my right we're excited at this opportunity i'm julius hammond superintendent sussex county public schools

[00:30:08] who has partnered with all of our regional community colleges and all the institutions in our region but more importantly richard bland has been a partner gosh even before you came on board when i was successful prior to petersburg we're excited the opportunity for expansion being part of the improved school portion if you will my colleagues and friends do it then we're on the ramp we're in lockstep with richard blaine college but this is we're excited at the opportunities

[00:30:42] and the pathways moving forward and more important not just our dual enrollment options but the health explorers option for middle school groups is something that will continue to again

showcase what we can offer whether the weather pattern and provide again digital pathways for our young folk to start exploring so glad to be here thank you thank you very much for your contribution and the collaboration on the partnership are there any other individuals for your community that you'd like to recognize please go ahead if you can stand from where you're at believe gentlemen is that going to be adequate the sound in the room do they need to get closer to a microphone

[00:31:19] My name is Jesse Vaughn. I'm the Chief Marketing and Communications Officer at the College of William & Mary. I just want to assure you that in terms of marketing for this particular project, I want to share with you some of our partners. We have partnerships when we reach our rural areas.

[00:31:44] We have partnerships with Summit Media, which has four radio stations that reaches that area, When we look outside the city on the outskirts of Richmond and Pittsburgh, we use Radio 1. And we have a strong partnership with CBS 6 in Richmond, which is also part of our outreach.

[00:32:03] And we also have a strong partnership with what we consider one of the top media buying companies in the state, where we reach through social media, Instagram, Facebook, connected TV, where you see on your phones, any kind of ads.

[00:32:18] what i'm here to say to you is i just want to reassure you that we will be reaching our community in a a plus level as far as marketing so there should be no concerns about outreach good morning i'm christy clark i'm the director of dual enrollment and high school programs at richard bland and i have been there about two years i had a strong background 25 years in k-12 so i can say that the work on this lab school project has been phenomenal our partners are heavily invested um we have a dual enrollment program that is strong but this will greatly

[00:32:55] enhance the opportunities for the children in our area particularly those in the rural areas living in the rural area having children in the rural area our students need those opportunities and not only the dual enrollment opportunities but all of these summer activities the weekend opportunities right now our kids don't have a lot of those but anything we can do to give them more an opportunity to compete with students from across the state it's just going to be fabulous so i appreciate the opportunity to be here and i think our project is well sound and we definitely

[00:33:31] have to buy in from our products so thank you thank you good morning i'm rcena portfield grants manager in the office of research innovation at richland college um we are very excited to work alongside the global academy our lab school um in the last 18 months we have obtained approximately 3 million in additional grant funding so thank you anyone else i believe that's it thank you thank you um at this time i'll go to the committee members for questions that they may have

[00:34:10] and i'll start with you with the vice president thank you thank you so much for your talk about certification about some of this kind of work it's like on the application it's um very impressive well from the very beginning and i'm just going to look forward to success for your students in the coming years just a couple of technical questions i can tell to the side you've got up from the number of students and the capacity and the five pathway programs and just to be wondering if there's more demand or numbers between one of the prioritization programs or

[00:34:49] if not as much for some of them that's dropped them or double down on numbers this will be sure kind of the supply and demand kind of matures and this is how we can dream We're definitely using an outcome mapping rapid feedback and assessment approach so the programs that are successful that

the students actually love and are learning is the programs will keep and we will quickly and actually Richard Glenn is known for this we actually what do we use

[00:35:23] fail quickly to move in the directions we need to go and the only thing I would add is just the customization piece that we really are as dr boyd said going to be in real time assessing we will build evaluation into every program that is offered and so we will be assessing is this working is this not working and making those adjustments in real time another question on that here it's really beyond expanded out to the rural areas just go to the new innovation center 100 the transportation

[00:35:58] needs again because it's uh just about getting really aware of just how far regions might be this time and the resources i hear you that way go ahead it's already in place

[00:36:19] In addition we also added we received a grant already that as a mobile marketing and engagement unit and in our Petersburg partnership we added two additional buses just in case we have any crossover little sprinters or we can get in and drive them ourselves and we are literally literally not even two miles from Petersburg high school so we are very close neighbors and we will

[00:36:57] we will be providing transportation for our students as we do right now for doing enrolling so transportation is not an issue Mr. Rotherham do you have any questions yes thank you Madam Chair I have a question kind of followed up I mean the exciting thing about this is the number of partners you have and then the number of potential partners some of the proposed um partners that are in there the the risk though that i see is you talked about we're going to evolve this in real time we're going to evaluate that's all great but who's ultimately going to be making those decisions because it seems like a complicated governance model so when you're getting that data back

[00:37:34] you're figuring out what's working what's not working who actually holds the decision um based on that so twofold one each of those record assessment points are total funding as we talk about sustainability. So use one. One rapid is with Department of Labor, back on track, we're looking at COVID, we're developing a unit there. So since it's all actually focused on sustainability, we also have grants and coordinators in that will help feed the information

[00:38:10] back to the governing party. But the governing party decides what we keep and what we don't keep, and we keep on with that whole rapid assessment process. And the governing party, tell me about that like i mean where i'm going is who is ultimately accountable ultimately richard bland college okay is accountable um in our governing structure richard bland college is a sign who's under our governing structure we do it lovingly with our partners but we hold the final responsibilities okay and then so then the final decision making on this as well okay

[00:38:44] thank you could i just add that um dr boyd i know you wanted to talk about we've got a year in essentially you've heard we've got transportation worked out we have programs that we've been able to secure through grant funding that very much go to um this lab school because we believed in it so much i'm just going to be really honest we were going to move forward regardless uh we just believe there is so much good work to be done and such an impact for our the area that we represent and serve um we've already raised as dr porterfield said quite a lot of money and already have some of

[00:39:24] these uh what i would call base programs already in place did that's actually thank you and our office of research and innovation actually already started the rapid feedback process so we're actually pretty good at qr code getting in doing the assessments and feeding back the information okay thank you

and if you do have the transportation piece entirely worked out including the just in time don't keep that to yourself i think there's a lot of i think there's a lot of place around the commonwealth who would like to have that wisdom thank you thank you dr moran thank you um hats off to putting this together and i do know that a lot of the pieces of the puzzle

[00:40:04] was obvious both in the proposal as well as just in my knowledge of the schools and that are involved in this that you've got a lot of pieces that are coming together that have been building over time this is not a new news um what is new about it is putting it all together so that rather than being separate puzzle pieces you're putting it into one exactly so you got it so and i was looking to see that in the presentation i did see y'all bring that together for me um there's an area in the curriculum that i really do think deserves some strengthening

[00:40:37] and that's the the a you um weigh this out as steam h and one of the things that i think about when you think about steam age is that there are so many different fields that are involved inside the medical community that involve arts whether it's digital animation illustration art therapy etc etc etc i'd love to see that strengthened in the proposal so that it's much clearer that it's not just art visioning for the for the perspective of the summer academy but it is something that's integral to the whole process. So kids learning about all the different ways that the arts can

[00:41:16] play into STEAM age. The other piece that I'm interested in is given the work that you're doing with the work around teacher training that's separate from this with VCU, what I'm really interested in also is that one of the hallmarks of great lab schools is that you have both teachers inside the system, getting really good professional learning experiences. And you also have teachers in training that are able to become better first-year teachers as a result of their

[00:41:52] experiences in lab school. Could you elaborate a little bit more on how you may be bringing teachers in training into this program? Absolutely. Thank you for your first comment to about art. I 100% agree. We were actually looking at programs for art therapy and using math to actually define art. There's the professors that we've been talking to about those different opportunities as well. So I 100% agree. That's where we'll add some more customizing and double down. To answer your question about the teachers, that's also why we're partnering with William and

[00:42:28] Mary, the Department of Education. Dr. Finocle is working with us to look at how we can advance and stimulate and they'll be able our teachers will be able to participate with their teachers in training at William & Mary and number two Longwood University will actually work with our teachers through their technology and innovation summer training program all of our teachers will have the opportunity to participate in that and that is actually already covered in funding through our national science foundation ethic grant which is enabling partnerships to increase innovation

[00:43:04] capacity so those are two other ways we actually want to build our teacher component awesome i i really do believe that the lab schools should be a destination for every school of education in virginia to say how can we get our teachers to get that innovative experience because i think it it really could elevate the uh the first year experience for teachers going into uh the profession and dr moran especially as artificial intelligence as generative ai plays a large larger role. This is top of mind for us because teaching is not going to be the same with the

[00:43:41] addition of that new resource. And so we firmly believe that helping teachers learn how to productively use AI and not just kind of say, keep it out of my classroom. We believe this is an element that

will make a huge difference as well. And then the last comment I'll make, and you've got some friends in the audience that I think will like this comment. And that is that I know that with the state building out the data science standards, that that should be something that you also consider as playing into this as well, because it is very much part and parcel of health careers. So thank you. Thank you. Mr. Bailey, I'm coming to you, sir. See if you have

[00:44:20] any questions for Richard Bland. Yes, wonderful presentation and application. I love what you're just going to take advantage of the guy. This is something to lean into to help teachers figure out I haven't used the classroom, I just saw the blog pages, just so stabilizing, just everything about your application, embracing the spirit of innovation there, just a couple other things that really struck me in the application, a lot of the idea of connecting some of these program areas to student interests, it is the way I think related to helping some of these

[00:44:56] subjects that are abstract and very difficult for students to throw their heads around and it more exciting so please look at them to be great with that also i love how the two math things uh often when we see stud schools that have become a little bit of a lead path but it is for students who are in the past year or kind of like natural lectures already science and technology and it's great to meet those but i love that second platform books that need more confidence and and often those are the most marginalized

[00:45:30] populations we see this a lot that the stem i love especially when it shows up in college goes way back to middle school so the fact that the building pathway to be very intentional about learning confidence i just want to remember that because i think that's going to be on just two questions i have you did mention the presentation but fame from the you mentioned faint a couple times and uh i had the chance to go visit uh paid in kentucky about five years ago

[00:46:04] with louis reed who's now a bipartisan working group who's now president biden's deputy uh chief staff which is strong like it's not powerful and maybe a good example that was just maybe go one click deeper on just what is the relationship with this program uh with faith and the faith implementation here jimmy i have one other question do you want um yes sir so the federation for advanced manufacturing education program we entered into that with secan the commonwealth center for advanced manufacturing um that program is now in

[00:46:42] its third year so uh we have been meeting to talk about ways to strengthen it but i couldn't agree with you more that in terms of setting a model a foundation an infrastructure if you will for getting students from high school into an earn and learn type environment that's the essence of what it is so working with those industry partners and currently we have eight active industry partners who receive those students as interns they are not making coffee and fetch they are not making

[00:47:19] copy and copying papers they are literally doing cnc work they are doing the work of advanced manufacturing on the job and they're getting paid so they work three days a week they go to class two days a week and the great news is they graduate from college debt-free or with very minimal debt so it's a win-win um every program in every state is structured a bit differently so we are currently in conversation with ccam about ways that we can adjust and improve that

[00:47:53] delivery we believe by adding more partners like bright point community college who has great lab space so it really is a ccam initiative richard bland has offered the programming for three years we've had a number of students go through it and i will tell you almost all of them get an offer of full-time employment and here's the best part those salaries are really good salaries they are high paying jobs and

they lead to very productive careers so thank you for bringing that up yeah now it's like one of the country's best secrets in some ways and the fact that we

[00:48:32] have fans tonight in virginia that you're working combining them with this lab school model i think it's just very powerful one last question in fact in early in your application you talked about in the crazy limited 12 you know students may have the option of being on campus for a full day or half day and it was that may that just struck me because it sounds like that's the decision the students are going to make and i just wonder how would you be giving them some advice and counseling on how they whether or not they should be on a full day or half day or just stand here you want to take that we'll have christy clark take that as our dual enrollment

[00:49:09] direct i don't know if you can see me but um you want to come over here i'll come on so this is this really goes back to those partnerships and having to work one-on-one with the school and the counselor that student's counselor to determine what the best pathway is for that student but we currently have students that attend with us 11th and 12th grade full-time we also have some students from uh some of our other partnering schools that may only come for one or two courses so it is going to be whatever the best needs are for that individual student

[00:49:45] one size does not fit all um many kids may choose to be on that associate's pathway but if they don't that's okay it's going to be what it is they need to because first and foremost they need to graduate high school and it's going to be what it is that they need so maybe the student in the stem has interest in math and and they may be accelerated in math in school and we can provide those math opportunities that may not be offered at their school so the may is going to be it may be what is appropriate for that individual student for that school and for that school district so

[00:50:22] everything is coordinated sir with the school district as we decide what if students will be on campus how what classes they will take as long as they fit into the standard and how we move everyone into the enhanced it is very much a partnership discussion yeah and i think the only thing i would add is that again we we have experience in this so we offer at least three different options and sometimes it's a combination so there can be online dual enrollment for students who need that option there can be in seat in the high school dual enrollment for students

[00:50:58] for whom that works and for other students being on the college campus and being um sort of treated as a college student is really the best option for them so may is simply addressing that for us again it's very personalized and customized that's great and it really embraces the customization you're talking about supposed to pose in what size that's all just trying to deserve what works best for the students so thank you i appreciate it thanks for experiencing your questions thank you thank you mr well first i want to say i had dr armstrong and i had a delightful visit to your

[00:51:37] institution i believe it's back and you met with your entire team sat for a number of hours and discussed your proposal what you're doing with that and i want to really compliment you on the response in the feedback was provided by the site visits we've really embraced the focusing in your application uh you've uh developed stronger partnerships not only with petersburg with with other school divisions i see that you have memorandums of understanding attached as well as letters of support from the superintendents and the school board members

[00:52:16] and i've done some diligence and it appears that you've had good conversations on the school board conversations in the superintendents as well and and certainly a very long and healthy partnership

with petersburg is and that's really important in this work that it be truly collaborative with school divisions and as a community college i think you're really showcasing that community colleges are a natural partner in the lab school endeavor you work so closely with k-12 schools you work so closely with through dual enrollment they have a lot of just as you stated experience

[00:52:50] being accessible and open to secondary students so i want to thank you for that and acknowledge that your comments have been responsive to the questions that i previously submitted as well i just have one question real quickly that i wanted to query on and that's given the number of school divisions that are now potentially involved please further discuss how your recruitment efforts will be handled across those school divisions and how will you apportion John Kane: Seeds by school division and some of our other applications we've seen.

[00:53:28] John Kane: Mary Washington probably a good example I could name a few others that there's kind of an apportionment of how many seats are available for school division and what's your thinking about that is that was. John Kane: It appears to be a work in progress and as you're working with the school divisions just kind of how are you thinking about making those decisions will be based on.

[00:53:51] local financial contribution will be based on interest from the students themselves and amalgamation of those two but what are you kind of thinking sort of a combination of those two but also in a perfect world we don't have to turn anyone away that is why we're also doubling down on grant funds for example we know that sussex is coming next we already applied for five rules student success initiatives with tuition included so i know that's me putting a hopeful and wishful

[00:54:28] point into the plan but i love to stay hopeful and wishful and build around that to look at what's the maximum we can do by the time we're at year three i would love for our discussions to be what's the maximum we can do from where we are at that point so give me a little more about that just so so it's going to be open by lottery to all students so uh it is on a space available basis so let's say you have x number of individuals that are going to be participating in dual enrollment during the school year what are you kind of estimating would be x number and how might you

[00:55:05] portion that okay so 25 students in op and optional 75 students in supplemental the students in supplemental we'd love to be preparing them to be moving into an optional track so ideally by use the ideal by year three because that's a hundred students that were actually given different dual enrollment courses to starting year one the 75 in the summer may take one class we're going to take them where they're at but the 25 that has the stronger ability and moving towards them they're definitely in working towards that associate's degree by the time we're at year three we we have

[00:55:43] agreed already to add in 15 more per other school division but how that is decided we actually want to have the governance board with a director over the lab school to be more engaged and making sure we do it thoughtfully and appropriately and that's still not the best answer for this and chair would just go the only other thing i would add is just that in our minds we are working with petersburg city to learn as much as we can to create a model that we can replicate that in the

[00:56:18] other area schools and so we do believe that we will learn a lot about capacity about interest about optional supplemental and kind of how best how we can best um educate the students depending on those variables. So I would just say we don't know enough today to really be hard and fast about the numbers, but I will tell you Dr. Boyd is pretty good at moving mountains. So if she has this vision that she's going to accept them all, I'm not going to doubt her because she really is

[00:56:58] so committed to this project and the belief. And I appreciated Mr. Bailey just speaking to the fact that we are trying to do something different here and we have got a head start on it. And so we are going to learn and we are going to create a great model in Petersburg and we are then going to push that out in ways, if I can just again be vague, that maximize the opportunity for every single student. But if I had to give you a number today, 25 dual, 75 optionally will be taking dual

[00:57:34] enrollment classes by the time the third year 15 from each of the other school sets will come in as a minimum requirement you know i'm a former school board i knew that all right i thank you for being responsive to the question and this this really helps us because even with our dual enrollment program right now we have so many students who apply but we cannot put them all in there because of our funding because we pay for it so this now gives them options that probably all students who apply now will have an opportunity to be in a program so this this is great it's a great insight thank you and thank you for being here it's always so lovely

[00:58:15] all right well at this time you're in a robust conversation and no further questions and dr armstrong i'm terribly sorry but we've enjoyed such a thorough and thoughtful conversation with our applicant that we've neglected to receive a report from you so let me summarize is there anything further that you would like to add for our deliberation excellent thank you dr armstrong so is there a motion to approve richard bland college uh lab school application on first and final review and refer it to the virginia state

[00:58:50] board of education for approval so moved thank you sir all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye chair votes aye as well mr bailey votes aye any opposed state nay the motion is approved five to zero thank you very much for your deliberation on behalf of the committee i direct the staff to post richard bland college application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures then compile any comments received for review by the board of education in may i also direct staff to finalize their report for the standing committee's comments from today and our endorsement and to compile that report along

[00:59:28] with the application and all the additional materials provided including the update of the appendix received by the standing committee and to refer that to the board of education's main meeting all right this time we'll proceed with item b which is first and final review of college partnership laboratory school application from old dominion thank you very much thank you so much

[00:59:56] 10 minutes behind all right great to see you as well thank you good to see you

[01:00:30] this must be the superintendent job that's right that's right all right welcome thank you you've heard the routine yeah i'm going to truncate my remarks um please proceed and welcome and please introduce yourself the role that you have with either old dominion or with the uh collaborating partner uh school division all right good morning chair i'm dr john we go with the third proud

[01:01:09] division superintendent of southern public schools and i have several of our staff members as well as some of our partners on my my media right is dr caitlin leitner our coordinator of science construction and stem innovation we also have dr akim branch our chief academic officer for sbs dr trish samirsky who's one of our partners with dominion university directly behind her we have Dr. Sinet, third and third, our chief of schools, and I see that we have Al Moore, our city manager for Suffolk, as well as Dr. Karen Sanzo from Old Domain University also. This is an interesting experience because when we first heard about the lab school application, we wanted to try

[01:01:46] to fit things from a different perspective, and we're really going to focus in on the elementary level. We believe that this might be your first elementary lab school application coming to the entire committee. We chose Booker T. Washington Elementary School, one of our older elementary schools, but also one of our most deserving and needing elementary schools based on our social economic status. To us, the entire focus is about access and exposure, and we wanted to continue to expand our existing project into great programs that we have in biomedical engineering in two of our three high schools and use aspects of vectoring that's actually tailored for that elementary level for Booker T. Washington Elementary School. I'm going to turn it over to Dr. Akima Branch,

[01:02:26] our chief academic officer to provide additional insights and of course we'll be open to more questions at the end. Good morning and greetings to all of you esteemed members of the committee. We are happy to present the STEM Academy at Booker T. Washington Elementary School or SAVTW, an innovative collaborative initiative between Old Dominion University and Suffolk Public Schools for your consideration this lab school as dr gordon has mentioned embodies an innovative teaching and learning approach and environment centered on stem science technology engineering

[01:03:04] and mathematics this morning we provide you with a high level overview you have our application so we'll highlight many of our main points from our presentation in our presentation of how our STEM Academy could become a cornerstone for an early elementary academic excellence, experiential learning, and innovative school in support of STEM education. I think that's my

[01:03:39] slide. Our educational approach for our STEM Academy is both innovative and research-supported. In partnership with ODU, we plan to utilize student-led and student-guided learning. STEM integration, and experiential learning to equip students with an awareness, understanding, and practical hands-on use of STEM in our world. STEM Academy is a strategic response to the need

[01:04:11] for STEM knowledge and skills for tomorrow's workforce and its future. Our mission at the STEM Academy is multifaceted, to inspire and expose STEM to students at a young age, elementary, and prepare them as future leaders and contributors to our society, especially those students, as Dr. Gordon mentioned, who may otherwise not be exposed to STEM and its overwhelming

[01:04:43] relatedness and importance in our world. Thank you. Good morning, everyone. Our vision for this labs well i'm very excited to share this with you today as dr gordon mentioned and dr branch we are starting young stem is not a thing it's thinking it's the thinking process behind it and we need our our little ones to be engaged in this work at a much younger age rather than waiting until we get closer to middle school in the high school trying to figure out what they're going to do with their next steps in their journey so our mission and vision is to generate 21st century learners at a

[01:05:20] much younger age before they figure out the course paths that are available for graduation and post-secondary education our instructional focus and our innovations is centered around stem education as dr branch had mentioned we will be aligning our curriculum with the virginia department of education standards of learning for k through five as dr gordon mentioned we will be utilizing the project lead the way curriculum that's already curriculum that's embedded within Suffolk Public Schools at the high school level. So our goal is to have a K-12 pipeline for STEM education for our students. In addition to our curriculum work for our youngsters, we are working

[01:05:58] with Old Dominion University as well for these mentor programs for our student interns at ODU. So rather than the work that occurs with your undergraduate level, bringing those teachers, those

potential teachers into our lab school to be mentors, to observe, to be able to co-teach and co-plan what it's really like to be in K-12 education. That is our goal with working with Old Dominion University. Work that we've done already in regard to professional development, because of course that is essential and needed, is we've started this work last year. We have developed a cohort of 21 individuals who have gone through design thinking training. That training

[01:06:38] was housed at Old Dominion University, and so we wanted to make sure that they had the capacity and we're ready to be innovative for this curriculum that we plan to establish and put in place. In regard to our enrollment projections, we are looking at kindergarten through fifth grade, 20 students per level, which would give us 120 students within our lab school at Booker T.

[01:07:00] Washington. So a day in the life of a lab school student here at Booker T. Washington. This might look like a traditional schedule, so I'm going to talk through what you may see. Hopefully you will come and visit us. Kindergarten class obviously will look a little bit different than fifth grade class you might be seeing students in our podcasting room making a podcast to be able to share with dr gordon potentially our school board city council on changes based on a problem that they have found in our local community potentially you might be seeing students with our 3d printers printing something in regard to their prototypes i'll give an example um for a

[01:07:39] third grade classroom that you might see as they go through their design thinking model let's say they are posed with the challenge that they are to create a more eco-friendly playground that is inclusive of all students as well as those in the community whether you are unconscious due to a broken leg from a sporting event or in a wheelchair our students notice the problem that we need a more inclusive playground for english they'll be researching what that entails what equipment is needed for this for that writing component they're going to be writing a proposal so that this can be put in place to our school board and local city council

[01:08:15] math they might be diving into your geometry facts here or even budgeting getting into decimals they need a budget to purchase the equipment needed science of course that's your stem so they'll be prototyping and designing the new playground for the local community social studies they'll need to do a little bit of research on our community the settlement in which we live on they need to look at plans to be able to figure out our next steps for that the resource classes course will be able to put it all together with our makerspace and our stem lab using computer science for coding and having plans set in stone for their day here is a graphic of our instructional

[01:08:52] focus here of course with the stem content being the lead force having all discipline areas and embedded within their day-to-day instruction students will be posed with real-world problems so not just building up the straws and keeping problem solves but going outside looking at their local community realizing where do we need adjustments and improvements here to be productive citizens they'll be going for that engineering design challenge design thinking process that's teaching them the empathy phase who is your audience that we need to create this potential

[01:09:27] solution for they'll go through the designing the ideating and just like any occupation there's always retest after seeing what your results are we might have to change our plan retest and revise so the skills that we're teaching students aren't just the virginia standards of learning it's the design thinking but it's what they'll experience when they get a real job of how that process is and how that process works so

with this instructional focus we truly believe we are building 21st century learners that will be equipped for tomorrow's workforce thank you

[01:10:02] so with our research model we use a design-based research approach that in addition to what you see here and the focus on teacher training that uh that caitlyn talked about uh we will be integrating uh public school uh public school teachers um old dominion faculty and business and industry experts and others in in the design and testing and evaluation of our practices and our innovation and that's really important because that gives us some again in real time

[01:10:38] we've heard that before ability to um for continuous improvement uh and also to continue to engage our uh our our key stakeholders in um the evolution of you know what we're trying to build and this would lead to our sustainability which i'll talk a little bit more about soon um we couldn't do this without our partners um these are some listed here and this uh this will continue to grow um we also have several uh partners on doom who you may hear from in a little while um but one of the things that i wanted to know that's been particularly exciting for me

[01:11:17] especially as a newcomer um is that about a year ago unbeknownst to all of us sitting in this room today talking about lab schools um is that uh some of public schools and ultimately began a conversation about just simply ways that we could work together and that evolved into taking a look at and visiting the classrooms uh for project lead the way where students are immersed in real world problems of and we took that that project and we created over you a series of workshops focused on manufacturing

[01:11:51] advanced manufacturing and also biomedical fields along with an additional partner which is listed up here of the hampton roads biomedical research consortium so the three of us since february have been offering a series of workshops at odu to extend the project with the way curriculum and in the morning when the students come and say it's a class of 11th graders they come several times a month and they are engaged in a lab in a 3d lab with demonstration and then they follow that with a dialogue with key industry experts and ODU faculty who are actually in the field

[01:12:31] where they're hearing about these demonstrations so because of this success we already have two two programs in the maintenance for next year in addition to that and this really speaks again to the deepened relationship we have with some of the public schools is that we have art exhibits offered um and some of the majority uh that will lead to events for the community parents uh students uh odu constituents that really celebrates these budding young art artists pay through 12 throughout um this district which is really wonderful again all right in the making

[01:13:09] our points for the next couple years um we also plan to continue our relationship with camp and roads workforce council and others can really stay in tune with what the key issues and needs are with stem education and stem initiatives within um within the region um i also have to mention here that with our early years ug undergraduate stem program and it is our monarch teach um this is a program where uh students stem teachers future stem teachers are involved in

[01:13:48] different types of field experiences and internships and they may be part of it so i think that's a perfect partnership in all of this our sustainability plan uh as i mentioned earlier all these relationships are really important to our sustainability and in this we'll leverage what we're developing as our stem regional ecosystem we'll continue to pursue grants um we do have some base funding that um that is embedded in our application and we have institutional commitment

[01:14:25] for both but what i really want to focus on here is the involvement of our development because i think here is where we have a really wonderful opportunity to celebrate and emphasize the wonderful things that are happening as mentioned at a very young age with the stem Academy of Liberty Washington but also with our other lab schools and we have a golden opportunity here within these ODU lab schools to work together to celebrate and and focus on the individual aspects of the three different lab schools but also ways that we can leverage the

[01:15:03] differences and you know other types of work that we're doing within them so when we talk about creating a really kind of a web or a network and a comprehensive development fundraising campaign i think it's important to look at not just one individual lab school but all three because i think that's so much part of our thinking uh in moving and moving forward um we also will continue to include uh ovu stem initiatives both with our faculty and our students and involve different

[01:15:39] committees uh in that work it's not moving there you go there you go okay so this illustrative itemized budget really speaks to some of the base funding that we have and it is part of the application um this is just here is a snapshot to show you that we have really been working on this and again i think i've done a lot of the uh work involved with that really knowing that we've been

[01:16:08] sitting here today uh so this this provides a snapshot because there we go um so in conclusion uh we appreciate the opportunity to be here today uh but yet but again i just want to mention that um this wonderful uh this wonderful uh stem academy at booker t washington is a way to reach children at a very young age and expose them to stem because stem is everywhere um and and it also is as a continuum uh with the rest of the lab schools and and the network that we're building

[01:16:47] around this uh to really grow together and um i i'm just as a newcomer very excited to be part with this team because i feel like so much work has been done already um and i just know that this is a very committed eager connected team uh to be part of this thank you so much are there any other individuals that are that would like to speak to your application that are here with you today sir would you like to say anything i know we haven't i'm not trying to put you on the spot this is one of those infinite school board meetings where oh my god you just got called down

[01:17:26] it's if you would like to um sure i'll take a few moments and kind of summarize what you heard today really excited about this progress um program um as tissue mentioned earlier we have a very close relationship with North, Old Dominion University, excuse me. And at least in 2011, we've been working very closely with Dr. San Miguel. But culminating, you know, then this year, next year is a capstone project where our seniors are going to share their ideas to change this

[01:18:00] world. What's really unique about our capacity with the process is that it gets them ready and my plan certainly in the project lead way program and one of the reasons is that i'm aware as a parent and so i can start by hearing that related to our last who is located dr gordon in june in one of our local social and economic areas right in the park center of our summer and so we're looking forward to grad uh grabbing those students that are very early age teaching them to think big

[01:18:38] uh think differently about the world and then um we already have the programs and places thank you sir dr gordon is there anyone else on your team that you want to make sure that has an opportunity to speak to the application yeah that's what dr sanzo wants to add any additional comments right now and she was probably okay certainly greetings dr sanzo lovely to see you again hey uh good

morning good morning it's really nice to see all of you as well and i uh appreciate the opportunity to speak to them as well um i don't know if i'm repeating anything

[01:19:13] dr bird said it's a little bit difficult to hear but just i want to emphasize um the long-saving partnership and in nature of this proposal um we have a leadership recommendation cohort that's underway in the public schools bringing in the educator prep component of it bringing in the professional development of the existing teachers and really looking at i would say the uniqueness that it is with something public schools but also building the ultimate university lab school network and as we spoke before this idea of connection and collaboration and community and we think that

[01:19:49] having that and again we're smiling out our experiences at utsa and seeing how they have that last network in which they've been able to um lead the program we feel will help it be very successful and also just the uniqueness that comes with having the elementary piece of it we think will also add to that as well um one of the other pieces that i think helps from the educator preparation component is we're allowing bringing in more educator preparation and new options for our students at the institution so now we have students who would go into elementary

[01:20:28] go into middle school go into high school with these different experiences um and i think that that will also make it much stronger as well overall um so just appreciate the opportunity of the partnership and we have one more partner here as well um to speak to that if that's okay with uh christina brooks miss brooks morning everybody hi i'm christina brooks workforce council i just wanted to thank you so much for considering this application and in the particular component of our stem talent pipeline and athletes trying to be special right now to propose how to bolster our it healthcare infrastructure and maritime pipelines in our

[01:21:08] region and this lab school is going to be incredible component to being able to develop the skills that we need so i just want to thank you so much and for your good news here thank you miss brooks i'm gonna say dr sanzo um at this time i'm going to go to mr rotherham hi thank you this is briggs exciting proposal. I just have one clarifying question. You guys are working formally with Project Lead the Way, is that correct? We are a Project Lead the Way division awarded and recognized nationally for our two teachers. We have biomedical as well as engineering at two of our high schools. Okay, I'm going to go ahead and recuse on this one then because they're a client

[01:21:45] with Bellwethers. I didn't see that application, but it's exciting to read nothing else into that then. It wouldn't be appropriate if you consider this one. Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Rod. I don't whether we wanted to get his input oh certainly oh okay that's good mr city manager my apologies sir thank you for being here we would welcome comments from you on this application

[01:22:28] to the support of the public school system of landless joint program between uh something public schools and older men in your body it's a fantastic opportunity for younger disabilities here at southern it will allow you to become more involved in the sciences technology engineering and mathematics in the early stage which will be beneficial in the long term explained by I hit it this way. I am 1981. I just had age myself. I'm in 1981 grads of engineering technology program, and that laid me a foundation. But prior to my journey was to add that you were going to

[01:23:05] college utility sector for municipal government for 36 years since a licensed engineer. In 25 years, I was a director called utility designer. Personally, there was a lack of all the technologies for engineering and technology fields and i like diversity which i think all comes together we're talking here

reaching out into the community where we need to develop that type of uh these last 15 marshes will be massive developing the stock fields existing but we're talking about existing efficiency and the city self-reporting supports this

[01:23:42] thank you sir and thank you for your support of school divisions in your area and for your partnership and collaboration on this endeavor as well um mr hanson i i see you making copious

[01:24:18] notes so i sense you're ready with a question or a comment thank you very exciting proposal i love the elementary school focus and to just love it and help us uh working something a little bit differently here so thank you um i don't have a conflict with budget midway but i'm a big fan and i've spent a lot of my professional years working in the department and just congratulations on your partnership and your relationship is awesome so i think i have a couple of mechanical

[01:24:53] questions i'm just trying to get my head around um how do you envision a cohort of students coming in and will they be progressing from the various states we provide or will be on ramps off ramps of the students depending on kind of where they are following and spending opportunities we do envision this to be a cohort of students and as with any enrollment as students transition there may be some spots for others we will have through the lottery system a wait list

[01:25:30] so those students can be added in we want this cohort to help us expand the stem academy to be a stem school um eventually so we're looking at this cohort which will be responsible and take the sol test and everything else that is required throughout for virginia but these students will be identified based on the unique instruction that they will be provided and we will use that to expand our program and continuing it to the middle school is the goal and then on to our

[01:26:08] project lead the way focus at the hospital question but just on the measuring success as well just both in terms of the academic achievement but also the growth of the program just maybe a couple of success indicators until we look at that we will be looking at because this will be a cohort model these students will test and be responsible for everything else that is assessed however we want to identify what we did specifically to engage their learning

[01:26:48] to increase achievement scores their scores will be included with the students but we will be able to identify whether those students and our design model our design thinking model had a great impact so there will be many milestone measures throughout we do that now in a nine-week setting nine-week time frame for our students across the board this will be a little bit more because we'll build will be building in more of a stem focus across the board they still will be integrated

[01:27:22] into our normal programming as far as resources etc but the focus for the lab academy is the stem and those students will be monitored and assessed do you mind if i'm sure in addition to the assessments the entry level service we want to hear from the students as well coming in and and their progression throughout.

[01:27:40] So we'll have measures to be able to achieve that, but also through the performance-based learning, there already are rubrics set in place that we plan to utilize in addition to the standardized testing measure. So lots of different measures to be able to get the student interest piece. It's a continuum throughout the school year.

[01:27:57] We'll be able to see their own personal growth just within the STEM field and those learning abilities in addition to our assessments. - Dr. Moran? - Yeah, thank you. you answered some of the

questions I had, particularly the one, and it's probably above your pay grade, but the one about how do you really bring together these three separate schools or lab schools? Because you have Suffolk, you've got Newport News, and you've got Chesapeake.

[01:28:27] Very different constituencies, but all kind of situated together. And so I appreciate you saying that y'all are going to look at that as a more integrated model for sustainability. One of the questions I had that may speak a little bit to Dr. Gordon being here, but one of the things that I noticed when I was looking at the quality profile on Booker T. Washington is you have about 340 some students there. And so if this is a success, what does it leave the kids that are not getting this dream big STEM academy experience? John, tell me what you're thinking is.

[01:29:06] that's a great insight by you dr moran because what you're watching is our smallest elementary school it's also part of the reason why we chose that school so our goal is to be able to increase the growth there and as dr grant said we want to start out with a co-growth of the student academy group 120 students right basically 20 students per grade level but the end result is to have a full stem school where we have four and fifty to four hundred sixty students that follow the power of how that we started in the academy and then later on in the life we may be coming back schools we're going to be able to extend this to the middle school level so that we have a direct pipeline to both our project lead away programs as well as some of the other concepts we're seeing

[01:29:44] for our advanced uh placement courses and our international back-to-way program there are similarities to what we're seeing when it comes to project based time and our project lead away programs we just got another email today as dr grant said that actually recognized that for both programs i believe this is the 18th year in a row so that's part of the reason why we chose that correct from why we want to be able to partner with that also because we can already speak to the end result from our high school teachers who are being able to provide some insight to some of the things they need for the kids to be successful with all of that and silence and like that uh also with the with the project that we have you know already played with that

[01:30:21] um we do have the teachers from some of the public schools presenting with our uh leading you staff on that relationship and i think they're going this summer to a conference in california to do that and i think they have another one like that so it's really exciting it's like we did not know that a year ago when we started that work so it's it's really exciting to see my my second quick question at least please is that i know that you really spoke to having internships from students at odu teachers and training so to speak do you see um even deeper

[01:30:58] level of focus for uh student teachers being woven in not just in the intern piece but in general yes i know dr sanzo might want to speak to this as well um but that's very much a part of our plan and we're very open to how that might look as we move forward with our planning and and integration of all those stakeholders that i mentioned earlier um but yes and those um Stem prepared, it's a long word, but the STEM prepared teachers that are now candidates

[01:31:32] are involved in a lot of these activities and innovations throughout the curriculum as they're enrolled. So we look forward to deepening that in whatever way we need to as we, you know, as we get this input forward. I was able to attend that International Association lab school conference this past month so gained a lot of knowledge in relation to that question that you just posed the other yeah miss sanzo i think

you wanted to be responsive to dr moran's first question i'm so sorry yeah yeah these are great questions and so i want to say a couple

[01:32:12] things one is when we presented to the board event and i would ask the same if you want so this is there for all of us um as we move forward and we're creating this research plan we have our questions that we're asking but if there are specific questions that you all want to ensure that we're building into our research model or that we're building into the program evaluation these are going to be more successful if we can get those curious questions and build them in um the reason why doctors and mercy is presented here is we're also recognize the very real issue

[01:32:47] of capacity and understanding the ways in which we can manage personnel and capacity at the institution so the institute for design thinking and leadership development will continue to provide support of overarching coordination across space three as we look forward towards tier five sustainability we imagine that we are more and more streamlining the internal services as we get to become more familiar with the ins and outs and nuances of what each of the schools require in terms of management leadership resources your question to your point here is the teacher education piece of it um the college of education has already created a

[01:33:26] director's and teacher partnership position and a portion of that person's line is allocated specifically towards the three lab schools and looking at the ways you can integrate um the teacher education but to your point it you know i mean i'm one of those now teacher and we lose so many people in that student teaching phase because they are not in there from the early stages and so looking at the ways that we can have students integrated into the early phases of labs it's really important for us one of the other pieces that we've been doing at wdu is looking at it in the care book i spoke to you all about this or the board of ed um at first crossing we have

[01:34:05] cyber security interns we have computer science interns we have those individuals in the stem fields and we've been we've been convincing them that teacher education is also a completely viable track so our hope is that we also now we have these teachers informal declare teacher educators coming into these preschools but we're also integrating completely part of their um education because if it was you everybody is supposed to have internship and work-based experience of course in the state now and so also having our cyber security stem students see us coming in then getting them to come into the education field looking at the ways in which

[01:34:45] we can provide them these teacher education courses too long-term hope is we have individuals graduating into computer science but also how do we get them that new certification and teaching so we have industry professionals that are certified so um it's not just those early teacher experiences but also the STEM field as well um I hope that answers a part of the question that's part of our long-term vision of we've already started that really this past year at first crossing and then getting those inputs and kind of data testing what what that would look

[01:35:20] like um we had kindergarten then last week that was really fun to us since our new security team working with kindergartners and then we're testing that out this summer as well and they're interns thank you dr sales do you have anything more that's okay mr bailey bring us home

[01:35:52] i just so appreciate the one group instead yeah um this this focus on commentary it just feels so important and i think we know we don't know uh we don't even research shows that we have a lot of students that are opting out of student pathways because they feel like they're not gifted they're not gifted

in math they're not gifted in size yes it's kind of the only subjects when we allow them thinking to be proud of like we never say students are just gifted in reading they're like kids are going to be good because they're going to be good at writing we're going to teach them so the fact you're engaging these kids so early i would think is um is so important you're going to be vital from

[01:36:32] this point in mind um the one thing i just wish you could click one step deeper because i really jumped out at you was um you had a whole section in your application about research the idea of there being institutional educator student level research and that just felt different it felt different than a lot of things we've seen and uh it just feels like that can be pretty powerful in terms of both helping people begin and develop that muscle what does it mean to come up with a research study pitch it and get funded and do it and execute it and you know publish it but i i could you just go like a little bit deeper about how would that be executed do you have a sense of

[01:37:08] what kind of research projects would come out of them sure i mean uh we yeah yeah yeah you're welcome to come to our meeting next wednesday we have discussed as a team that we're taking a design-based research approach so we're doing it out to the organization level as well um and so we are planning on using both our program evaluation model as a mechanism for which we can also engage in research at kind of broader lab school components and then zoom again

[01:37:46] as we engage in professional you know teachers we really want to dive into so actually more teacher-based that is only basically which one faculty and teachers are identifying for their pdsa model processes and what do they want to plan to do what are they studying how are they predicting uh the outcomes for their instruction and really modeling that pdsa process we want to get teachers comfortable the administrator's comfortable first and i think this speaks deeper to the question of what's it look like when you have this kind of books within a school it's not as though the last school teachers are the holders of all knowledge and it's a secret we want to study the

[01:38:22] ways in which these ancillary benefits of having these last schools embedded within the schools within a broader school system so so just study how that uh how that the lessons of instruction in teaching um innovations are dispersed throughout um but having teachers engage in that action research more to broader dvr model we want to get them integrated into aera's american educational research association getting them immersed in the vernacular field um upskilling them around research having administrators are part of it and then as we think about the design

[01:38:58] thinking process leveraging that as a mechanism through which we can have students articulate their research so what is the why getting down into your causes asking those how might be questions asking and then helping students make that make that shift from how might reach really these deeper level research questions that they want them to articulate and we don't get our students can do this up to seniors and then we would like to um so this is for the seniors and we can see this happening in suffix we have our um teacher um aspiring writing educators coming in

[01:39:33] what do they want to learn about instructional practice what are their hypotheses when they come in and they end the day um are teaching these lessons and then so we want to have researchers involved we want to have teachers involved we want to have students involved um one of the plans probably around year one or two of the implementation is to have these mini grants that are taken from some of those lab school funds we're able to require and incentivizing our teachers our researchers and students to partner collaboratively around researching these pressing problems in

[01:40:08] practice and this is where our partners industry leaders are coming in these signature questions these are these are social problems that we want you to study and learn and understand these are problems technological in the field and create solutions um and then be able to present them in pitches uh to have these expositions of learning annually um it would be our hope that we will transition to a place where parents would be able to hear about this research but also disseminated

[01:40:41] more broadly in the national scale um as cable mentioned i am last and what it it was such an amazing experience here that i am less than ever and to hear the students themselves present their research projects and that was part of what kind of made it click for us when we went out on the team and now it's not what's being able to do and we want as it as i would you know i'm going to bring campus as well out of the region to be able to be a host site for ios in the future to show these signature last experiences um does that answer your question your research there's a lot

[01:41:25] mr bailey thank you mr bailey thank you dr sanzo um so i just have one comment really for your application you know i have been incredibly impressed with the quality of the applications coming from ODU. I'll be the first to say when I heard that there were three applications from ODU, it caught my attention. Curiosity of how possibly could one institution have three applications.

[01:41:54] The interaction that you've had with IALS is evidence. All three applications, this application in particular as well, hits all three elements that uniquely define a lab school. First, you have invested in educators you have educators rising you are intentionally thinking about high quality professional development for educators in the commonwealth that is item number one item number two you have deeper learning for students in a variety of formats and number three is dr sanzo

[01:42:30] has just eloquently and i love your enthusiasm dr sanzo uh outlined an element of research to not only research and evaluate which is a very important consideration in this work evaluate your work but to share your learnings with others to improve the practice of research more broadly within the education tools those are the three elements that immediately define lab school and without question you have all three and i just the evidence for that comes through in your application it comes through in our conversation and the deliberation i want to thank you for that

[01:43:07] engagement it's nice to have those exemplars out there thank you without further ado at this time is there a motion to approve odu suffolk's lab school application on first and final review and to refer this to the virginia state board of education for approval and consideration in may is there a second second all those in favor of the motion please indicate by stating aye The chair votes aye as well. Mr. Biali votes aye. Any abstentions? Abstain. Abstain. The motion is approved for zero and one abstention. Congratulations and thank you. Thank you so much.

[01:43:44] At this time, on behalf of the committee, I direct the staff to post the Old Dominion University's application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the Standing Committee's procedures and compile any comments received for review by the Board of Education in May. I also direct the staff to finalize a report for the Standing Committee's comments from today and our endorsement and compile that report along with the application and all additional material received by the Standing Committee as well as additional items added to the appendix and refer that to the Board of Education in May.

[01:44:13] All right, now we can do handsheps. Thank you. Sorry, sorry. We got to go on. We got to go on that list. Thank you so much.

[01:44:28] I appreciate that. Thank you, y'all. Thank you so much. Thank you. - Okay, I know I can bet it's right side.

[01:44:44] That's a big challenge. Yeah. - Yeah. - Yeah. - Okay. - All right. So, welcome.

[01:44:59] Welcome, welcome. - How are you? - Good to see you. At this time, the committee is taking up item C, which is first and final review of the College Partnership Lab School application from George Mason University. good afternoon and welcome thank you very much good morning uh so i just saw superintendent coons here so and wanted to wish it uh uh thank you for being here and of course the distinguished members uh of the standing committee thank you for inviting us to this opportunity and uh this is the super strong tool for all the help uh through the space uh the shindawa valley rural

[01:45:38] regional uh college partnership laboratory schools uh that will focus on a specific theme data science computing and applications and we have acronyms as dsca all over the application it will be led by george mason university and there's a collaborative project with seven uh partner school districts and one governor school in the shenandova valley with frederick county as the lead K-12 partner. The seven partner rural and rural fringe school divisions include

[01:46:16] Clark County, Fakir County, Frederick County, Page County, Shenandoah County, Warren County, and Vincenzo City, and the Governor's School at Mountain Vista. Now, GMU will also leverage the expertise from faculty in the GMU College of Science, GMU College of Engineering and Computing, The Complete Center, which I direct, which is a joint center between the College of Science and College of Education and Human Development.

[01:46:39] The GMU Smithsonian Mason School of Conservation, SMSC as we have acronymed it, and Laurel Ridge Community College to engage students and teachers in this GMU Data Science Computing and Applications Lab School. My name is Padhu Sishaya, and I am a professor and director at George Mason University, and I've served in multiple leadership positions, including the Associate Dean for Academic Affairs, the Director of the STEM Accelerator Program, and the Director of the Center for Outreach in Mathematics, Professional Learning, and Education Technology, which is the joint center between two colleges.

[01:47:18] And I also serve the past four years as the Virginia Data Science Pirate Lead on Standards Writing and Implementation Teams for the new high school data science class. Good morning, and my name is Deb Crawford. I'm Supervisor of Mathematics and Moral Language in Frederick County Public Schools, and I'm an instructor at George Mason University in the Math Center.

[01:47:41] I co-lead the Shenandoah Valley Computer Science Regional Partnership, which, as could be said, is comprised of 11 partners, including seven school divisions, three higher ed, and a governor's school. And that partnership really spawned the roots of this lab school.

[01:47:58] Additionally, I've also served for the past four years as the K-12 data science lead with the course development of the new data science course and the implementation cohorts. And that piece has triggered the role of this data science and computing applications lab school as a teacher hub for professional learning for teachers.

[01:48:21] And also, both of us bring a lot of experience to help build this college partnership lab school. Dr. Crawford has served on the original advisory board to create the Mountain Vista Governor's School, which still operates and is a part of the Shenandoah Valley Regional Computer Science Partnership. And

as the Associate Dean of College of Science a few years back, I have helped with the Governor's School at Innovation Park, which is a partial academic year Governor's School program with a focus on STEM disciplines serving Manassas City, Manassas Park, and Prince William County.

[01:48:58] So the lab school will be a data-focused school offering an emphasis on advancing data science, computing, and applications through innovative research and education. The proposed lab school will help build on successful best practices these regional partners have already established through eight different projects across three VDOE, Advanced Computer Science Education Grants, that helped enhance this regional partnership.

[01:49:28] We were able to develop a micro-pilot lab school over the past three years, and that component allowed high school students over those school years to engage in capstone projects, earning college credits at George Mason University in the area of data science, computing, and applications.

[01:49:48] Those projects will be replicated in the lab school for all students, so all students do research in the lab school. In another exciting related project, Dr. Seshire and I helped to serve on the respective K-12 and higher ed leads in terms of the creation of the new data science course and implementation for the Commonwealth, which is now taught by about 50 high school teachers.

[01:50:11] And this is new. These teachers need professional learning in data science and computing in the age of AI. and Virginia is the first state to have its own data science standards of learning that were approved by the board of education in April of 2022 and this uh exciting uh data science course we are going to be running the third institute uh this summer and within a week we had 100 teachers we don't have a math we don't have a data science team we have math teachers CTE teachers we're all

[01:50:43] excited to teach this class. So the lab school in particular, the lab school, it actually employs a hub and spoke model that will be led by GMU working with VDOE and Frederick County Public Schools as the hub, where the physical lab school will be located. And along with lab school opportunities provided through the George Mason University, Smithsonian Mason School for Conservation and Laurel Ridge Community College.

[01:51:12] And the SMSE is located in the Front Royal Campus for students, teachers, and parents from all partnering divisions, and they serve as the spokes. And Double J Howard Center, which is in Frederick County, her principal is right here, serves as a specialized educational facility offering a variety of programs and services to meet the diverse needs of students in Frederick County area by committing to a non-traditional process for earning various credentials

[01:51:38] uh that can include a high school diploma as well let me just slide so data and it goes fast backwards make sure it stands there okay so data and computing provides a significant competitive advantage in today's society you know with the need to expand the talent pool to address workforce needs I serve on the Virginia Workforce Development Board with uh Secretary Slater and need to create new programs designed to help students add this data science computing and

[01:52:16] applications expertise to their skill set also with governor youngkin's recent executive order on artificial intelligence which is issued in january executive order 30 the need to prepare the next generation workforce in the commonwealth on opportunities presented by ai innovations from data science and computing now it becomes even more important and recently just last month the national council for

teachers and mathematics released a position statement that i had the honor to serve on as an author saying that data science is a high school mathematics course that

[01:52:50] can be used for credit towards graduation so why rural rural and rural fringe divisions such as those in the shendo valley are often overlooked in terms of these opportunities and and yet they are part of the American education system 10 million strong about one in every five students nationally and so um we are excited and proud to bring data science and computing applications to the valley targeted facilities investment at dowday howard um such as you know

[01:53:28] the data hub that will be established there an industry standard hub for students to learn and grow in and develop that skill set for the workforce could pay dividends in improving rural education in our area the proposed school will also help to equip the teachers with design learning experiences that in fits their needs and in terms of also their students through this lab school as a teacher hub and all of our partnering divisions would have the teacher professional learning part of this grant through project-based learning experiences in the

[01:54:06] lab school oh there let me just okay uh the lab school actually as uh dr crawford mentioned uh okay thank you the lab school uh it'll be hosted physically at dow j howard center in frederick county public schools it'll serve students each year as a full lab school the lab school students and the partner division faculty will also have the opportunity to take dual enrollment coursework

[01:54:44] and professional learning opportunity opportunities through the regional higher ed partners including gmu smithsonian conservation center and laurel bridge community college and the proposed school will serve 50 students from grades 10 11 12 who will have the opportunity to engage in data science computing and applications through five common experiences which aligns with foundational competencies by the national academy of engineering and these include like an interdisciplinary coursework experience research and creative experience design thinking i teach design thinking so i was excited to hear design thinking the last presentation and entrepreneurship

[01:55:21] experience work-based learning experience and global and multicultural experience and all students will have the opportunity to earn a directed online data analytics focused certification through companies such as google amazon and many more and students in the lab school will also have the opportunity to earn an associate's degree from laurel rich community college and college credit from george mason university and industry certifications from partnering organizations and on the teacher hub side one of the novel innovations by the proposed lab school will be the development of digital badges and micro credentials in data science and computing for

[01:55:59] our teachers in the Commonwealth. And also, these leadership and teaching badges and micro credentials will be developed in conjunction with George Mason University and Laurel Ridge.

[01:56:15] These will serve as tangible evidence of the skills that the teachers are earning. And it's exciting because they are cost effective and possibly more efficient than what we've done before with professional learning. And most importantly, they can be customizable, accessible, and stackable for teachers. Both Dr. Seshire and I have experience working with micro-credentials through VASCD, the Virginia Association for Supervision and Curriculum Development. We develop micro-credentials for data science around inquiry-based learning in data science and

[01:56:51] community partnerships for data sets and problems for kids to solve. So up here, you'll see the day in the life of a data science student. And what you see here just briefly are sample schedules for our 11th and 12th graders within the industry aligned data hub kind of serving as the center.

[01:57:14] Note that travel to and from the lab school from the base schools allows the opportunity for lab school students to engage in after-school clubs and sports and be connected to their base school. The schedule shows also how two elective periods per day allow for customizable workforce learning options, graduation requirements, both for advanced studies for some, advanced studies associate's degree for others and advanced studies for some, and university research for all. So that university research with research with university mentors is for all of the kids. And these mentors

[01:57:53] will be from the Smithsonian Mason School of Conservation, also George Mason University, Laurel Ridge, and so forth. And so when we look at their schedule, you see base learning electives allow for three pathways. One is the certification. And so having that valuable certification school to work is one another one is research university research all students and the third is that opportunity for an associate's degree let's start here just one yes i know that one of our committee members has to leave but i feel like he's very interested in your application i'd like to

[01:58:28] recognize mr roffer yes thank you i apologize um the job of paying bills um uh i'm really excited about this a couple of things first of all again basin and you all for us um uh uh what state board our last meeting the last group at our meeting prior to this one and that's why i can make your leadership uh on this i'm also really excited that the counties that you're choosing to serve they are kind of too often overlooked and left out of the conversations and counties like page shanando and so forth that's extremely exciting and then finally the research opportunities um my daughter was able to do research while she was in high school as a member uh do research at

[01:59:07] george mason to a program uh but they know it's absolutely tremendous for her academically some opportunities for her that are going to help carry her to college so that's sort of what you're doing um i think it's absolutely by any chance this is the asip program no it was new leadership excuse me yeah it's fantastic presented on the day all right okay just really cool and so i just think like what you're doing uh for young people who have geographically and in terms of the opportunity to create it was just fantastic thank you thank you very much thank you very much thanks

[01:59:42] for those comments so one of the very uh unique things is uh because we have uh spent a lot of time developing the high school data science class students in the lab school will have the opportunity to engage uh throughout the curriculum what we call as no code low code and high code uh experiences so the primary difference is uh is in the level of coding expertise needed so the degree of customization and control offered and the target audience so no code environments will allow students with limited or no programming experience to create functional applications using pre-built components and low code development experience will provide visual interfaces pre-built components to enable students to create application with minimal hand coding and the high

[02:00:21] code will expect uh some writing software from scratch uh using traditional programming languages and so this illustration indicates the various project activities and milestones that are being proposed for various stakeholders including leadership from all partner divisions students in 10th 11th and 12th grades as well as teacher and parent opportunities the program activities are color-coded to be either curricular that offer college course credit opportunities research that

[02:00:57] offer college course credit opportunity to do research on data and computing and careers so those offer coursework on college success skills teacher professional development through continuing ed and annual virginia high school data science and computing to enhance the pedagogical practices for teachers upskilling and reskilling our teachers one cool thing our outreach includes super data saturdays for our students this will attract students and teachers and parents to wanting to go to the lab school and so those super data saturdays will be open to our community

[02:01:37] students and parents they'll be held at the smithsonian mason campus and so community-based will include parent information sessions on the state-of-the-art developments in the lab school get their input to enhance the curriculum with community-based projects competitions which were already involved in with our regional partnership which will allow students to participate in regional and national competitions and then workforce elective where students will have the opportunity to earn additional certifications apprenticeship opportunities and intern internship

[02:02:12] opportunities and involvement with the shenandoah workforce development and in the last four years we've been working together uh through advancing computer science education grants from the department of education and it was first focused on teachers but then it evolved into bringing students from their classes and this is how uh this whole vision started so uh there is also a roadmap for teacher uh teachers as designers and learners here and i'll be brief um due to time but this roadmap shows teachers as designers and learners within the lab school environment and

[02:02:48] And these projects you see here, we have done many of them as pilots in our regional partnership already over the past four years. And so we're building and enhancing on these opportunities for teachers to be designers and learners throughout this.

[02:03:06] And so I'm going to not go into too many details, but if you check up there, you'll see that it involves the same things we've been talking about. Research, industry certifications, and again, the opportunity to have different pathways such as an associate's degree or other college credits.

[02:03:27] So, yes, just sustainability, or would you like to? We do. Maybe we can ask them to speak. Yeah, let's do it. Maybe we should go to them if you don't mind. Yes, absolutely. Please, please. And also the Executive Director of the Smithsonian Conservation Center. So let's go with the students.

[02:03:49] Let's get to the students first. Michelle, do you want to start? Michelle did research projects with us. Michelle, go ahead. So, I did computer science research linked to Noveli.

[02:04:12] My project was basically on how I trained a convulsion and a lever of architecture to detect and recycle plastics in bodies of water. So, while I had my time during last year, I learned a lot about machine learning and data science because they had some workshops,

[02:04:33] And so I'm talking to the baselines of how to do things, and they had mentors, and I worked with Dr. Casey from OBU, and I worked with Mr. John Merrifaw, who is on campus right now, and they were able to guide me through the process of just creating one of the general projects and doing the research and then giving me the resources that I need, but ultimately it was my own project that I did and executed.

[02:04:58] And so I found it helped me a lot throughout the college application process, and it was able to keep like an equal focus on other counties that may be more like resourceful than us. It was able to give

me a lot more opportunity, and it was during the summer I did it, so I was able to do it like outside school hours during the regular school year.

[02:05:21] Thank you, Michelle. Bennett, do you want to jump in, please? Bennett's from Millbrook High School. Yeah. Thank you. all those topics my grad student is also doing so thank you michelle hey i i also did the class last year as well my project was trying to identify students who graduate college of four years less so that way financial aid programs could better distribute aid to each of them and reward their efforts and i should say that while the class has been very helpful in

[02:06:00] teaching data science and it definitely changed my outlook on the world at the same time there's definitely challenges that come in the class online such as technology the promise that we have from school just make it very difficult to do the project and do work so i don't rely on my home computer which i know that i haven't had and it might be unreliable in crashing times and then also just communication with teachers and professors online can be difficult so having

[02:06:31] And there are teachers right next to them who are actually, you know, our ambassadors, actually. So could we ask them to speak also? Jill, please? Jill, could you actually say a few words, please?

[02:06:55] Ms. Keenan, can you also say a few words, please? Yeah, so there's a couple things I'd like to talk about regarding the lab schools.

[02:07:14] I know, I think Dr. Bunker has mentioned about how great it would be if students could earn these credentials, be able to earn money, and then either use that money in their life life or to apply it to their education in college. Where we come from, which Ben and I are, we are actually members of the Microsoft YouTube program, which brings volunteers into

[02:07:51] the classroom to offer through life experiences and applications. And one reason why we're children in Virginia is because of our high levels of diversity and rural setting which fall many ways to some lower income and then have this opportunity where students could develop skills that can help them earn more money would be really beneficial for the students in our in the counties as dr cheshire has mentioned the partnership we come up with

[02:08:27] george mason students like ben and michelle um the products they've done has really been when you give these students the opportunity to pair with college professors and able to do research and then share out the research they mainly just develop these prototypes but if we had a lab that they then take it a step further these prototypes were developed based on problems

[02:09:00] identified with the national engineering grand challenges so it's you know it's beneficial to their community their state country whatever work and to be able to take it a step further and to continue their research and have technology that will allow them to not only process the data that they want but also to collect it especially through community partnerships would just be amazing so miss keenan thank you so much thank you so very

[02:09:36] much for your professionalism and for your element of advocacy for your students thank you it's a delightful pleasure to have you come here today as well as you mr weiss and uh we very much appreciate your from you as well as miss wayon congratulations on your research it sounds tremendous and please continue forward in your journey i know you will but you're certainly making virginia proud so thank you so much for your contribution today thank you and we have two more teachers also somebody from uh george mason too could be uh cody could uh are you able to speak

[02:10:10] he's uh cody edwards is the uh interim dean uh for the college and he's the executive director of uh the smithsonian uh mason conservation center cody are you there i thought i saw you i'm i am here yes i am and i appreciate it great yeah i appreciate the opportunity to be with you today and to talk about this lab school i also speak for our colleagues at the smithsonian when i say how excited that we all are about this proposal um and there's a number of reasons for that several of which that you've already heard from the students from purdue you know and from

[02:10:50] others um but but for me you know it is there's two or three i think really impactful and novel pieces here which benefited students certainly but also teachers in these communities number one has been said several times this area is an area that is undisturbed and so the smithsonian mason school of conservation is based in front world square front and center area we realize the opportunities that oftentimes are are missed or not provided to these students and to the teachers

[02:11:24] of life and so it's exciting to think that um there'll be a hub with more opportunities for that now the second piece to this again to me when i look at this proposal i hear from these students it is impactful there's no question about that but it i think it offers an opportunity that you don't see from a lot of programs today and i'm not talking about lectures i'm talking about education systems particularly in higher ed that we don't focus on we focus on learning facts right and we're educating those facts on exams or whatever it really is an important thing i think

[02:12:01] that you're hearing from everybody here today is it's it's that experiential piece right it's it's solving problems learning how to solve problems and that translates into just about any field that you can go into from teaching to engineering to computer science to business right it is all about problem solving and i think this lab school is unique in the research opportunities the problem solving opportunities that it presents certainly uh estimates see you know in a world

[02:12:36] where everyone says everything is one of a kind estimates these truth you won't find a partnership with a what the smithsonian calls themselves a forever institution and they indeed are a forever institution probably the only forever institution and so the opportunities that these students will have available to them that the teachers will have available to them is unlike anything i think anyone else could replicate so that is incredibly exciting certainly incredibly exciting to george mason university but also very exciting to the smithsonian this is an area that they have not

[02:13:12] done admittedly they have not done a good job of engaging um they're you know because of their simple focus in dc generally that 20-25 mile radius is where they focus most of their energy and so this is an area that they have long wanted to they've been out in front row for decades but engaging this community has always been elusive to them for a number of reasons and so they see that it's not a way to make a real impact in the region to support students to support parents and to support teachers so um i'm gonna give us some so many problems could not be more thrilled just

[02:13:50] for those i'm excited i really appreciate the opportunity to talk today happy to answer any questions or provide it thank you thank you mr edwards thank you very much yep the principal here hello yeah many members i'm i'm extremely excited to be here i will tell you i took over this principal yeah sorry yes ben thompson principal of dow j howard um yeah so i'm extremely excited to be here committee members i would tell you i took over as principal two years ago at dow j howard with probably my top goal was to expand uh or offer new programming for kids at dow j howard

[02:14:28] we're an alternative education center and we're also a cte center primarily career technical education is the primary primary student body that we have at dow j howard my personal goal as 10 new programs in 10 years and we're well on our way we have added criminal justice a pilot program for 20 students for about three more weeks we'll hopefully after the school board meets we'll have a full-time instructor to add 80 additional spots and then additional nursing and nursing instructor for uh certified our certified nursing assistant program we have the right staff we have

[02:15:03] the right students and it's the right time for us the right time and the reason i say it's the right time is the demand in our area for through our application process was roughly 700 or 700 students for half of that number of spots that we have at dow j howard uh the right students our students and staff are achieving at a high level most recently uh they went to the skills usa competition in norfolk every single kid for dow j howard that competed every single kid so they're achieving at a high level it's an investment into our community uh we just need your help we need your help to be

[02:15:40] able to support a bigger program for kids at dow j howard uh so that we can do what's right for our community and kids thank you thank you thank you ben dr shashay do you have others that you would like to have speak yes uh we do have another student that would give reference to a student so Kelly and Annabelle yeah please and Kelly yes sir all right here hello my name is Annabelle I'm a current student within the JMU student-led research class and I also just recently took the

[02:16:13] Shenandoah University data 195 class and um right now I'm working on a research project with my intention was specifically about autism spectrum and asd diagnosis and the reason that i found this program to be very unique and very helpful for my personal goals is because this is kind of like a passion project something that i'm very interested in and throughout this career i've been thinking about research and thinking about how i can apply my ideas and i i definitely

[02:16:51] use the things i've learned mr fair plus class and computer science but what these two classes have done for me as a student has allowed me to combine the computer science aspects of coding and apply it to something new world with the research projects and learning like data analytics um modeling etc i'm currently in the process of making these research projects and working closely and five minutes were such a stock and proper and i greatly appreciate um all the

[02:17:26] resources that this program has provided um i am not not only able to not only able to pursue like actually the actual research but also the connections um and the connections and the resources that this program has provided it's been a wonderful experience and i'm to be honest i'm now considering shipping data science yeah we didn't know this we didn't know this thank you letting us know dr huff dr huff is the regional director for governor's school and martin mr

[02:17:59] kelly yes absolutely thank you i appreciate your time um my name is kelly huff i'm the director i'm here and michelle and annabella as you can see are just exceptional students in this program Mr. Paragloth, my computer science teacher. Our research for Ridge is very unique. I just personally have been with Mountain East, so this will be my fourth year. In the four years that I've been here, the computer science associate degree, the pathway that we provide students has grown.

[02:18:33] When I first came in and we graduated, we found eight students. We're close to 30 now. It is up-and-coming students love it they love mr fireball and being able to add that data science component to it exactly what annabelle shared with you um would just be exceptional not just my nameless students but

everybody in this um exception co-worker um and i'll turn it over to mr barryon because he is the man with it all um you know i'm just fruitful um so i'll let him speak

[02:19:05] to the nature of how it impacts the university's happening yeah um i would say that for me the important part is to see the growth of these students when they get the opportunities to do this research and the connections and the resources they're provided um by i'm such higher I mean, Dr. Crawford and the other department of the university, see that growth in them and see, as Annabelle talked about, I heard seeing a passionate project.

[02:19:41] And it's also the same with Michelle when they went after it. You know, it's something I didn't do as a high school student, and I'm just so happy that we provide that to them. And I think it opens a lot of doors for them, from the employment perspective and leading into the university's barriers thank you thank you before we uh miss annabelle i want to say first thank you on behalf of the entire committee student voice is so central to the work and our deliberation here and i want to thank you so very

[02:20:20] much for sharing your experience and congratulate you on both your academic rigor as well as the passion by which and the fathers were having so thank you for joining us could we have one more teacher speak two minutes absolutely brian 60 seconds so brian that wants to be able to ask yes

[02:20:51] oh mr the last one i'm so sorry i didn't realize that you know what you think you're full-time you've been patiently waiting you've been online with us and you were early on so you know you get your full time consume as much time as you may need and we have here the virginia high school computer science teacher of the year brian thomas yes yes yes okay all right so so um it's good afternoon good afternoon um so brian thomas computer science teacher in french county public schools um this composed lab school is perfect for our school system um our educational

[02:21:28] stakeholders appear to have high expectations for our students and this lab school will be those expectations um as the um computer science um essentially grades grown and more grades also in french behind the public schools the last five years is basically grown tremendously here um the one thing i like among our big browns is very right with all types of students and we've had the struggles to teach computer science and recognition for diversity they have courses so that's one thing that we need to be focused on and make sure that we include all types of learners and uh i'm confident that our students our schools this is my area are priming candidates for this

[02:22:06] computer science that is good thank you thank you thank you and congratulations on your tremendous accomplishment as an education professional i i can't like we're getting applause from the room thank you so much congratulations he's amazing he's amazing he's amazing and thank you i'm so sorry we took you away from your classroom but thank you again for being here all right at this time i'm going to go to mr hansen he's president of the board and first questions or remarks just thank you all i love the approach and respect though mr rotherham's comments too about the

[02:22:45] region and i was just actually out in chester weekend for a you know birthday call from the grants um i'm just really you know i'm validating the phone and keep there

[02:23:09] really want to thank the students as well you guys are incredibly impressive and make me feel a little bit like a dinosaur from my time when i was your age just congratulations on what you're doing but and obviously this is an alumnus of mason i just you know my heart with what she does as a urban uh

suburban campus since i've been there a long long time ago and this is extending uh your footprints um both geographically but also programatically it's just

[02:23:43] really impressive and so i just um and also i really love royal ridge uh i was actually at our math sol uh public hearing over there last summer that's right yeah i was really able to again see the um a little bit better picture of the community and its role in the community while i was there and so this is the perfect footprint for um making this program successful um i really don't have any question and then when we just kind of bypass the sustainability side i'd just be interested

[02:24:26] absolutely so i can make this quick so i'm a former uh program director from the nsf and i had my my portfolio was about 26 million to give away so i really learned the ropes in terms of you know how to choose good proposals so now you know with all that experience there's lots and lots of programs at the nsf that we are applying to already through the you know because of the planning grant and we have a nasa application already in actually with frederick county as partners and uh the entire all the shenandova valley school divisions we have a afosr grant

[02:24:59] already uh submitted so these are all in review but uh there are several so that is one uh aspect is applying to federal and Virginia Department of Education grants, advancing computer science education grants. The other one which we are very big on is both for-profit and non-profit foundation. So, Vettel Corporation, Broadcom, we already have some grants from them, but we haven't really applied for lab school activities and all that. So, as we expand on or build on what we already have, so that's something that we are going to be going after.

[02:25:32] the for-profit we have talked to several companies and that are all very excited about and it may not be direct uh in terms of uh funding but it will be in terms of internships so for example if they're offering internships each one will cost money to them also so this way well for these kids i want to see them in in the summer you know working with some company and then showing off what they all learned and interest them and probably do much better than them so you know so those internships apprenticeship is another one that we are actually also looking uh so looking at the local businesses in shenandova valley and actually doing summer exciting activities but then follow up in fall

[02:26:10] and spring but then earn course credit through george mason so for that work so this is something that we are so and then uh also uh we'll follow some of the other governor school models where you have the partnering districts so you know after a certain point uh we'll work with the tuition formula with the people funding and all that stuff dr marianne do you have yeah i appreciate you illuminating a little bit of that because that was one of my questions is how do we make sure that each of these lab schools has a sustainable future yes because it would be

[02:26:48] i think exactly what we would not want to see if we came to the end of five years and we saw many of these shut down because of that so thank you for uh sharing that one of the other areas that i'm really interested in is how um from a professional development focus that uh both teachers i know that you talked about and deb and i know you're on the staff there as an adjunct but also having some of the gmu student teachers in these areas coming in so i'm really interested

[02:27:24] no this is a great question actually um this is a data science and computing and application so right now most colleges of education in the state and across the country do not have a data science education program they have a math education program they have a science education program data science is a very different space by itself it's it involves mathematics education statistics education and

computer science education data science sits at the hub addressing a domain and if we can so yes so we have not we're not just focusing on the students that are uh you know coming straight from the college of education but also stem students that are starting in the college

[02:28:01] of science college of engineering and then ask who want to teach and so we're going to identify those those students and give them the opportunity to work with the college of education and then work with them to get their licensure aspects and all that but it's it's great because right now there is no official licensure for data science so this is exactly something that will be evolving and in terms of sustainability those certification and the micro credentials that we are going to be creating out of this people are going to look for it so we'll have charges for those things and all that at some point it'll be it'll go through go virginia and so it'll be something that that'll

[02:28:35] help sustain also and then my second question is i'm thrilled to see a focus all the way through this on student mastery that this is not something that looks like it's going to be time dependent as much as it is skill and knowledge dependent competency dependence i'm wondering if you might talk about that a little bit because you know i think that teachers all over the country have been saying for years can we start focusing on something other than seat time in high school right great question so each student will have a personalized dashboard and we're working with

[02:29:13] companies to develop that and this dashboard imagine that each student can can develop a portfolio but also a skill set through um a dashboard i don't want to say the name of the company but it has modules where kids would do a pre-assessment and then go in and take modules in the data hub with the teachers in the data hub based on what they're working on and it has built in performance assessment all the way through and it leads of course to a certification so

[02:29:47] So, in itself, it's self-checking and also it's not time-dependent as one student might be able to test out of a whole bunch of modules and focus on what he or she needs and another might go a different route. And we have, sorry, the data science course already has a nice student rubric that we created.

[02:30:11] So, we're going to be matching those student rubrics also along with this development as so you know i think if yeah if i go ahead from an application standpoint the alternative education side of our building is very very good at that they're very very good of not a seat time but skill dependent right and so under the leadership of miss nicole johnson our primary administrator for that program being able to leverage some of her skills and get get that subset to this program would be uh vitally important uh and then our program leader mr caden thurgood for uh career

[02:30:46] and technical education, but his experiences in the real world, as we would say, through policing and whatnot prior to coming to a career technical education administrator, he will leverage some of his skills and knowledge of not so used to just that time or seat time as opposed to skill and then get the skills that you need. And then let's master that and move forward. Our school motto is best as the standard. So we want to ensure that we're doing that at that level. And this customization also you know a kid may want to do restaurant and hotel management but the data skills that we are giving they could create a dashboard and sell the dashboard to the companies that's the type

[02:31:22] of thing you know in terms of meaning or if they can predict which coffee sells the most at 2 pm on a wednesday starbucks will hire them for 100k so this is the type of skill so we're going to let the kid choose what they want to do but then the data is the holistic training that they're going to get and they can choose what they want to go after so many times that it doesn't matter whether a student's going to work in

a small business where they're going to work in the trades whether they're going to go into a highly professional career um faculty is the data science is an area that all students are watching that's right it cuts across all those things and virginia is ahead

[02:31:58] of the curve yes we are so thank you thank you thank you dr ran mr bailey uh just a couple it's one thank you so much for the students today and i mean it was just great and inspirational and just um it brings us to life two i love this one too thanks so much for calling on the governor's order on ai which is one of the first states to really you know create an executive order to help set up a process and beginning to give out responsible ai and back to reference that and it really keeps us at the table just because we know data science is super different from computer

[02:32:37] science as you were just mentioning and it is really going to be in the future not just the data centers in virginia but this whole ai wave they're reading right now it's just kind of great massive demand for data sets we mentioned this happened there's also going to be a lot of private data systems that could be people you know have been locked down because we did what distincts mentioned machine learning and maybe it's just feels uh just really kind of future-proofing uh support so thank you for doing the only question i have can you just go a little deeper

[02:33:12] on some data industries certificates i saw at times um like a google certificate was referenced but i couldn't tell the students would burn it and you mentioned some adfs certificates but what kind of industry credentials are going to be out of this yeah so well so we are going to so for example google already has a data analytics certificate where you have they have it in modules so we uh once you finish about two of those certifications they are almost guaranteeing you a job so you know so uh so they already so we're going to tap into the google's uh data analytics certification aws we actually have them as a partner uh coming to give our teacher uh

[02:33:52] resources and so they are just building their own certifications right now cloud computing certifications and all that and uh and comptia is another one that we are working with also uh which already is a very uh you know they have a sleuth i mean lots and lots of certifications that we're going to choose from and all that so and uh so brian thomas do you want to chime in i know you have worked with certifications also yeah i know in french county we go for our students certifications um and the good thing about it is some of the certifications we partner with

[02:34:28] was to pass that certification they will get the college credit certification i know we have So, one of them, they pass a lot of information that I've made granted on the Lord Riggs or Virginia for many parts of the class of E152 and then also, on the programming side, they take a Microsoft Technology Associates from Java certification, if they much pass that, it's just the equivalent of the Java programming .

[02:34:56] So, a lot of these situations, we try our best to try and see, we partner with the Lord And it's a very advantageous to students on that level of getting college credit, you know, there's no plans where on these certifications are what students need to actually graduate from hospital because every student need to have it.

[02:35:28] in the planning grant we are currently working with laurel rich working with george mason and how those things can be transferred also to a four-year institution so uh not just don't mean they could want they may want to go anywhere so you know uh so we want to make those pathways also easy for them so thank you so much any questions thank you thank you mr bailey well i want to say that your application makes me grateful when i think about what the nature of a lab school should

[02:35:59] It is first again support for teachers, it is innovative learning opportunities for young people, the opportunity to have deeper research and learning, to have a sustainable plan, and to really have a deep partnership in a local community with school divisions.

[02:36:18] And all of those elements are satisfied in the application, and I want to thank you for that. Thank you. Thank you for recognizing that. Is there a motion to approve Jordan Mason University's Frederick's lab school application on first and final review and to refer the application to Virginia State Board of Education for approval?

[02:36:38] So many. Is there a second? All those in favor of the motion, please indicate by stating aye. Aye. The chair votes aye as well, and the motion is approved by the Board of Zero. Congratulations. - Thank you. - Thank you very much. Thank you to all online. - Thank you to our team.

[02:36:56] - A wonderful team, best of luck, I'm sure that the State Board will look forward to seeing you. Thank you, Michelle. Thank you, Bennett. Thank you, Annabelle, especially. They all came out of their class. Now go get some lunch. All right. At this time, on behalf of the committee, I direct the staff to post the George Mason University application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the Standing Committee's procedures, then to compile any comments received for the review by the Board of Education in May.

[02:37:21] I also direct the staff to finalize the report with the standing committee from today and our endorsement and to compile the report along with the application and all additional materials including the additional appendix that has been received by the standing community for all those materials to the state board of education for their main needs thank you thank you thank you for your wonderful work so thank you this time we're going to proceed with the discussion of

[02:37:44] current items by any other committee members thank you let's wait all right discussion with current issues any items for the go-to-date order

[02:38:16] um I have one sure uh I was really interested in looking at the summer calendar that we actually have a meeting scheduled on July 3rd I'm I'm not going to be able to make that meeting so I didn't know how other folks felt about it but I wondered whether we might look at not meeting in July since have done a lot of work this spring to get these uh applications through process and so i just want to put that out to the committee as i see the nods of staff like saying take mercy on this

[02:38:54] uh mr bailey and mr nanson how would you feel about that i'm sorry a great idea a great idea mr bailey would you concur is that accepted okay so i see a motion i see a second all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye the chair votes aye the opposed gosh help you all right the motion is approved zero july is released removed thank you and there could be some others too and there's there could be some others as well thank you dr moran for being so proactive um the only other any other items for the good of the order okay um before we close out i do

[02:39:30] want to make one comment i do want to personally thank the president of the state board of education grace creasy for her support and leadership to ensure that uh for this meeting today to ensure the materials were distributed to the committee members in a timely fashion as well as distributed and made available to the public i'm sincerely grateful for her support and time and leadership and her partnership with the committee and our particularly for this statement so thank you for that um any

public comment on non-agenda items dr armstrong hearing none um at this time we stand adjourned our next scheduled meeting is monday june 3rd thank you so much



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